

Ramakrishna Reddy Kandala

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Professional Summary

Results-driven Senior DevOps Engineer with 7+ years of IT experience, including 4+ years specializing in Azure DevOps, CI/CD pipeline design, cloud-native infrastructure, and DevSecOps practices. Expert in Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS), Terraform, Docker, Helm, GitHub Actions, and Jenkins. Proven track record of delivering zero-downtime deployments, infrastructure automation, and security hardening across enterprise environments. Certified Azure Administrator (AZ-104) and Azure DevOps Engineer Expert (AZ-400). Passionate about Agile collaboration, GitOps workflows, and continuous improvement.

Technical Skills

Cloud Platforms	Microsoft Azure (AKS, App Services, Azure Functions, VMs, Storage, Networking, Monitor, Key Vault, Azure AD, Entra ID), AWS (EC2, S3, basic exposure)
CI/CD & DevOps	Azure DevOps Pipelines (YAML & Classic), GitHub Actions, Jenkins, GitOps (ArgoCD, Flux)
Containers & Orchestration	Docker, Kubernetes (AKS), Helm Charts, Container Registry (ACR), HPA, Cluster Autoscaling
Infrastructure as Code	Terraform, ARM Templates, Bicep, Ansible
Monitoring & Observability	Prometheus, Grafana, Datadog, OpsRamp, Azure Monitor, Application Insights, Log Analytics
Security & Compliance	Azure Key Vault, RBAC, Managed Identity, Microsoft Entra ID, WAF, NSG, Pod Security, OWASP, DevSecOps
Scripting & Automation	PowerShell, Azure CLI, Bash, Shell Scripting
Version Control	Git, GitHub, Azure Repos
Backup & Recovery	Veeam, Azure Backup, Azure Recovery Services Vault
Programming & Frameworks	Java, Spring Boot, Maven, Gradle, Hibernate, RESTful APIs, SOAP, HTML, CSS, JavaScript

Certifications

- Microsoft Certified: Azure Administrator Associate (AZ-104) — Microsoft, August 2025
- Microsoft Certified: Azure DevOps Engineer Expert (AZ-400) — Microsoft, September 2025

Education

Bachelor of Technology (B.Tech) — Jawaharlal Nehru Technological University Hyderabad (JNTUH) | 2013 – 2017

Professional Experience

HCLTech

Senior DevOps Engineer

May 2022 – July 2025

Client: Verizon Communication Inc.

Project 1: CI/CD Automation & Cloud-Native Deployment (.NET on Azure)

- Designed and implemented YAML-based multi-stage CI/CD pipelines in Azure DevOps for .NET Core microservices, integrating SonarQube code quality gates — cutting manual validation time by 40% and release cycle by 30%
- Integrated GitHub Actions for automated PR validation with branch protection policies, ensuring no defective code reached production
- Configured Azure App Service with blue-green deployment slots for zero-downtime, risk-free production releases
- Secured secrets management via Azure Key Vault with Managed Identity and Service Principals — HIPAA-compliant, zero hardcoded credentials
- Built Azure Data Factory CI/CD using ARM Templates for parameterized, environment-aware pipeline promotions across dev, QA, and production

- Optimized multi-stage Dockerfiles for .NET, Java, Node.js, and Flask services — reducing image sizes by 45% and container startup time by 60%
- Deployed containerized workloads to AKS using Kubernetes YAML manifests (Deployments, Services, Ingress, HPA) with TLS termination, auto-scaling, and load balancing
- Configured Horizontal Pod Autoscaling (HPA) and cluster autoscaling to handle traffic spikes while maintaining 99.9%+ uptime SLA
- Deployed Prometheus and Grafana monitoring stack for AKS, reducing mean time to detection (MTTD) by 50% and improving infrastructure visibility
- Integrated Azure Monitor, Application Insights, and Log Analytics for full-stack observability across 100+ microservices pods

Technical Environment: Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, YAML, Azure App Service, SonarQube, Azure Key Vault, Managed Identity, Azure Monitor, Application Insights, Log Analytics, Azure Data Factory, Docker, ACR, AKS, Kubernetes, Helm, Prometheus, Grafana, PowerShell, Bash

Project 2: AKS Infrastructure Automation & GitOps Implementation

- Architected modular Terraform and ARM Template IaC for AKS clusters, Azure VNet with peering, Load Balancer, and ACR — reducing provisioning from days to hours, enabling repeatable multi-environment deployments
- Managed Terraform remote state with Azure Storage backend and state locking for secure, collaborative infrastructure lifecycle management
- Containerized Java Spring Boot and .NET microservices with Docker multi-stage builds (35% image size reduction); packaged with Helm charts for standardized releases
- Configured ACR with geo-replication, content trust, and Azure Security Center vulnerability scanning for secure image distribution across regions
- Enforced RBAC and Azure AD integration for AKS cluster auth with Pod Security Policies and least-privilege access for 50+ developers
- Implemented GitOps workflows using ArgoCD and Flux for declarative, version-controlled application lifecycle management on AKS
- Deployed Prometheus and Grafana via Helm for AKS metrics and proactive alerting — reducing infrastructure MTTD by 60%
- Configured Azure Monitor and Container Insights for real-time log aggregation and performance tracking across 100+ microservices pods
- Secured AKS ingress/egress with Azure NSG, Application Gateway WAF, and private endpoints — protecting against OWASP Top 10 threats
- Automated AKS cluster operations (node scaling, backup, disaster recovery drills) via Bash and PowerShell scripts — improving operational efficiency by 40%

Technical Environment: Terraform, ARM Templates, Bicep, AKS, ACR, Azure VNet, Azure Load Balancer, Docker, Helm, Kubernetes, Azure AD, RBAC, Prometheus, Grafana, Azure Monitor, Container Insights, Bash, Azure DevOps, NSG, Application Gateway, WAF, ArgoCD, Flux, OWASP

Nextrics Software Solutions Pvt. Ltd.

Software Engineer (DevOps)

March 2018 – May 2022

Client: Prudential Global Insurance

Project 1: Secure Infrastructure Automation & Compliance Monitoring

- Migrated legacy microservices to AKS using Terraform and ARM Template IaC — provisioning Azure VNet, Load Balancer, and ACR with fully automated, version-controlled deployments
- Implemented Terraform remote state management with Azure Storage backend for secure, team-collaborative infrastructure across financial services environments
- Containerized insurance microservices with Docker multi-stage builds (40% image size reduction); orchestrated deployments using Helm 3 with Helmfile for environment-specific configs
- Hardened ACR with private endpoints, content trust, and Azure Defender for Container Registry — ensuring SOC 2 and PCI-DSS compliant image storage for sensitive data
- Configured RBAC and Azure AD SSO with Azure AD Pod Identity for AKS, enforcing least-privilege access and eliminating service principal secrets
- Deployed full Prometheus, Grafana, and Alertmanager monitoring stack via Prometheus Operator — created SLA/SLO dashboards and reduced incident response time by 55%

Technical Environment: Terraform, ARM Templates, Docker, AKS, Helm 3, Helmfile, Prometheus, Grafana, Alertmanager, Azure AD, RBAC, Azure Defender, SOC 2, PCI-DSS, Bash

Project 2: End-to-End CI/CD Pipeline for Java Microservices on AKS

- Built Azure DevOps YAML CI/CD pipelines for Spring Boot microservices: Maven/Gradle build, SonarQube quality gates, Docker image build/tag, ACR push — full automation from commit to registry
- Designed CD pipelines deploying to AKS via Helm charts with rolling updates and blue/green deployments for zero-downtime production releases
- Integrated Azure Key Vault secrets (DB strings, API keys, certificates) into Azure Pipelines and AKS pods via Managed Identity — eliminating plaintext secrets throughout the pipeline
- Automated AKS, ACR, VNet, and Key Vault infrastructure provisioning with Terraform for reproducible, consistent environment management
- Implemented Prometheus & Grafana for container metrics and Azure Monitor for application-level logging — providing full-stack observability from infrastructure to application layer

Technical Environment: Azure DevOps, YAML, Java, Spring Boot, Maven, Gradle, SonarQube, Docker, AKS, Helm, Azure Key Vault, Managed Identity, Terraform, Prometheus, Grafana, Azure Monitor

Client: Travelzoo, USA

Project 3: Reservation Platform — Backend Development & CI

- Developed RESTful and SOAP web services for a high-traffic travel platform serving 28 million members globally, implementing Spring Boot microservices with Hibernate ORM
- Applied MVC, DAO, and Singleton design patterns for scalable, maintainable architecture; participated in code reviews and unit testing with JUnit
- Coordinated requirements, development, and delivery across onsite and offshore teams in an Agile delivery model

Technical Environment: Java, J2EE, Spring Boot, Spring, Hibernate, RESTful & SOAP, Maven, Log4J, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, JSP, SQL, SVN, JUnit, Eclipse

Key Achievements

- Reduced deployment cycle from hours to under 15 minutes through end-to-end CI/CD automation across all environments
- Achieved and maintained 99.9%+ uptime on AKS using HPA, cluster autoscaling, and blue-green deployment strategies
- Eliminated security vulnerabilities by enforcing Azure Key Vault across all pipelines — zero hardcoded secrets in production
- Accelerated infrastructure provisioning from days to hours using modular Terraform with remote state management
- Reduced MTTD for infrastructure incidents by 50–60% through comprehensive Prometheus/Grafana and Azure Monitor observability
- Enforced SOC 2 and PCI-DSS compliance for container image storage and access management in regulated financial services environments